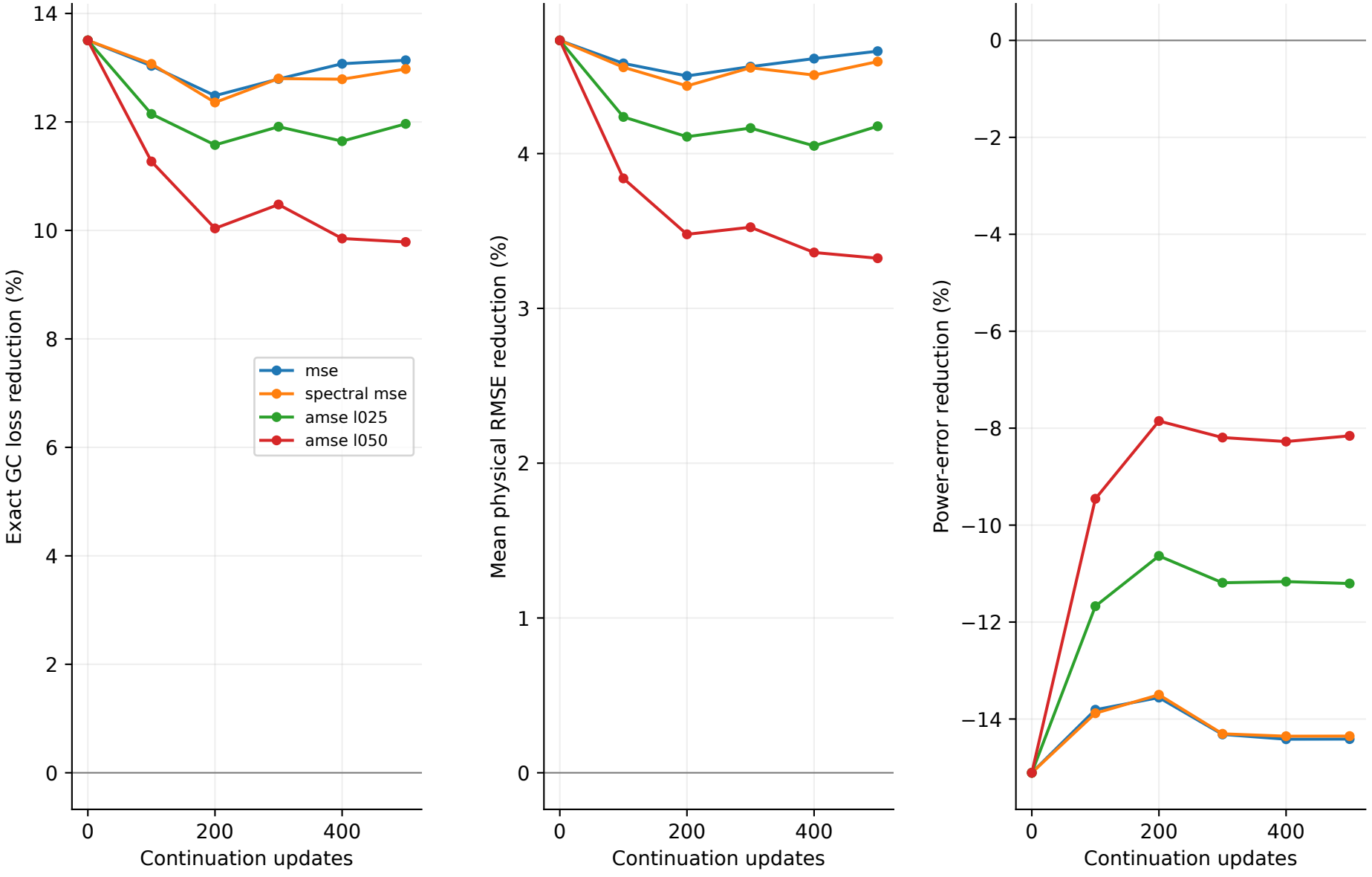
500-update pilot: increasing AMSE trades accuracy for power



Common mature-MSE start; four matched 500-update continuations. All checkpoints shown; all fail joint qualification.